

Huntington Bancshares

Business Development Dossier

Industry	Financial Services
Revenue	\$7.4B
Employees	20,000
Ideal Customer Profile Score	88

ICP SCORING MODEL



ICP = Signals + Revenue + Employees + Fit (max 100)

Signals (0-35)	Top 4 signals scored; each = base(60%) + recency bonus <30d: 40% <90d: 30% <180d: 20% older: 10%
Revenue (0-25)	\$500M-\$10B sweet spot -> 70-100% of 25 pts Below \$500M -> pro-rata x 0.5 Above \$10B -> 60%
Employees (0-20)	2,000+ preferred (70-100%) 500-2K partial (50-70%) Below 500 -> pro-rata x 0.3
Fit (0-20)	High-fit types: reorg, transformation, M&A, hiring, funding, partnership -> 5 pts ea (max 12) + diversity 2/type (max 8)

Prepared March 19, 2026

McChrystal Group

Leadership Advisory & Organizational Effectiveness

SECTION 1

Organization Snapshot

Legal Name	Huntington Bancshares Incorporated
Headquarters	Columbus, Ohio
Founded	1866
Ownership	Public (NASDAQ: HBAN)

Footprint

21 states, nearly 1,400 branches. Legacy Huntington: Ohio, Michigan, Indiana, West Virginia, Pennsylvania, Kentucky, Illinois. Legacy Cadence: Texas, Mississippi, Alabama, Georgia, Tennessee, Florida, Louisiana, South Carolina.

SECTION 1b

Company Overview

Huntington Bancshares is a Columbus, Ohio-based regional bank holding company. Its \$7.4B merger with Cadence Bank created a top-10 US bank by assets with \$276B across 21 states, significantly expanding into Texas and the Southeast while pledging to maintain all Cadence branches.

SECTION 2

Financial Health & Growth Stage

Understanding Huntington Bancshares's financial position and trajectory is critical to framing any engagement conversation.

Combined entity: \$276B in assets, \$220B in deposits. Pre-merger Huntington revenue ~\$6B; Cadence added ~\$1.4B. Transaction projected to deliver 10% EPS accretion and \$365M in pre-tax cost savings. 2027 projected ROATCE of 17%+. Analyst sentiment positive on the strategic rationale but cautious on integration execution given the geographic and cultural distance between the two franchises. Key tailwind: Southern/Texas markets growing faster than Midwest. Key risk: integration execution determines whether the deal model works.

SECTION 3

Leadership Team Profiles

The following contacts are recommended as primary outreach targets - champion-level leaders who feel the organizational pain daily and can sponsor McChrystal internally.

Unknown - Chief Integration Officer or SVP of Integration [PRIORITY TARGET]

Unavailable

Outreach rationale: Integration leader owns the \$365M synergy target and no-branch-closure commitment - this person faces the hardest organizational challenge and needs external support most.

Unknown - Chief Human Resources Officer [PRIORITY TARGET]

Unavailable

Outreach rationale: Cultural integration between Ohio-headquartered Huntington and Texas/Mississippi-rooted Cadence is the defining people challenge.

Additional leadership team members relevant to the engagement:

Stephen Steinour - Chairman, President and CEO

Former CEO of Citizens Financial Group; deep banking M&A experience including TCF Financial acquisition in 2021

Zachary Wasserman - Chief Financial Officer

Former Citigroup executive

SECTION 4

Organizational Culture & Structure

Culture and structure are often where McChrystal Group finds the deepest leverage. The following signals indicate how Huntington Bancshares operates today and where friction exists.

Organizational Structure

Traditional bank holding company structure with regional divisions. Post-merger, must integrate Cadence's Southern and Texas banking model (relationship-driven, community-focused) into Huntington's Midwest operating framework. The no-branch-closure pledge means organizational efficiency must come from back-office consolidation, technology integration, and process optimization rather than physical footprint reduction.

Culture Signals

Huntington has a reputation as a customer-friendly, community-oriented bank (known for '24-Hour Grace' overdraft policy). Cadence Bank, formed from the 2021 merger of BancorpSouth and Cadence Bancshares, has its own integration scars - some Cadence employees have already been through one merger and may be fatigued by another. The geographic and cultural distance between Columbus, OH and Houston/Jackson, MS is significant. Glassdoor reviews for both banks show general satisfaction but concerns about merger disruption and uncertainty. [INFERRED: merger fatigue among Cadence employees who went through BancorpSouth-Cadence merger in 2021 is a real risk]

SECTION 5

Recent News & Trigger Events

The following developments from the past 18 months create urgency and provide natural conversation entry points for engaging Huntington Bancshares.

1. 2026-02-02 - Huntington completes \$7.4B Cadence Bank merger

Creates top-10 US bank; integration execution begins immediately

2. 2026-06-01 - Mid-2026 system conversion for Cadence customers [SCHEDULED]

High-stakes technology migration - customer-facing disruption risk

3. 2026-01-06 - Both shareholder groups approve merger

Strong stakeholder mandate for the deal

4. 2025-09-01 - Huntington announces Cadence acquisition agreement

Deal announced with \$365M cost savings and no-branch-closure pledge - sets the integration parameters

5. 2021-06-01 - Huntington completed TCF Financial acquisition (\$22B)

Prior acquisition experience - integration playbook exists but may need updating for geographic/cultural expansion into the South

SECTION 6**McChrystal Fit Assessment**

active trigger (merger closed Feb 2026), clear organizational challenge (21-state integration without branch closures), identified budget (\$365M cost savings program implies advisory budget exists), and the no-branch-closure pledge creates a unique constraint that makes organizational transformation the only path to synergies.

Primary Problem

Achieving \$365M in annual cost savings from a 21-state bank merger without closing any of the 390 acquired branches - requiring organizational efficiency, cultural integration, and technology convergence as the sole levers.

Best McChrystal Capability Fit

Cross-functional alignment and shared consciousness across geographically dispersed, culturally distinct banking operations. McChrystal's Team of Teams model enables decentralized execution (regional bank autonomy) within shared strategic alignment (one Huntington culture and operating standard).

Likely Objections to Engagement

Huntington has successfully integrated two prior acquisitions (FirstMerit 2016, TCF 2021) - they may believe they have the internal capability

Cost-conscious post-merger environment may limit advisory spending

CEO Steinour's experience with prior mergers may create confidence that doesn't match the unique challenge of Southern/Texas expansion

Competitive Advisory Landscape

McKinsey, BCG likely candidates for integration strategy advisory

Accenture or IBM for technology integration

Korn Ferry or Spencer Stuart for leadership alignment

SECTION 7

Conversation Entry Points

These questions are designed for a Senior Partner's first conversation. Each opens a thread that naturally leads to McChrystal Group's capabilities without a direct pitch.

1. How is the no-branch-closure pledge shaping where you look for \$365M in savings - what's the organizational equivalent of branch rationalization when that lever is off the table?

This question acknowledges the unique constraint and positions McChrystal as understanding the challenge deeply.

2. With Cadence employees having already been through the BancorpSouth merger in 2021, how are you managing 'merger fatigue' in the Southern and Texas markets?

Shows awareness of the human dimension that integration playbooks often miss.

Recommended Meeting Framing

Position as an expert in organizational integration where the traditional levers (layoffs, facility closures) are constrained. McChrystal has experience building shared consciousness across dispersed, culturally distinct units without centralizing authority - exactly what Huntington needs.

SECTION 8

Brand Insights & Market Positioning

Brand strategy reveals organizational priorities and coordination challenges. The following analysis connects Huntington Bancshares's market positioning to potential McChrystal engagement opportunities.

Huntington's brand is built on customer-friendly policies (24-Hour Grace, Asterisk-Free Checking) that differentiate it from larger banks. Cadence's brand is rooted in Southern community banking. The brand challenge: unifying under Huntington while preserving the community-bank feel that Cadence customers chose. Marketing integration across 21 states requires coordinated campaigns that feel local - an organizational coordination challenge. [INFERRED: brand unification will test whether the combined entity can deliver on Huntington's 'people-first' promise at double the geographic scale]

SECTION 9

Deep McChrystal Group Fit Analysis

This is the strategic case for pursuing Huntington Bancshares. It synthesizes findings from all previous sections into a comprehensive engagement thesis with specific fit dimensions, expected outcomes, stakeholder mapping, and a phased pursuit strategy.

9a. Fit Dimensions

Fit Dimension 1: No-Branch-Closure Integration

The commitment to maintain all 390 Cadence branches eliminates the most common M&A synergy lever. Every dollar of the \$365M target must come from back-office consolidation, technology efficiency, and organizational

redesign. McKinsey can model where the savings are; McChrystal builds the cross-functional teams that actually capture them without disrupting customer relationships.

Fit Dimension 2: Geographic & Cultural Expansion

Huntington is expanding from the Midwest into Texas and the Deep South - fundamentally different banking cultures, customer expectations, and competitive dynamics. This isn't a bolt-on acquisition; it's a cultural expansion that requires shared consciousness across regions with distinct identities. Korn Ferry might assess leadership fit; McChrystal embeds the operating model that prevents regional balkanization.

Fit Dimension 3: Serial Acquisition Integration Capability

Huntington has acquired FirstMerit (2016), TCF (2021), and now Cadence (2026). Each was progressively larger and more geographically distant. The firm needs to build institutional integration capability, not just execute one integration. McChrystal's repeatable frameworks for cross-unit coordination scale across future acquisitions.

9b. Cumulative Case

Signal chain: \$7.4B merger -> no-branch-closure pledge -> 21-state geographic expansion -> mid-2026 system conversion -> serial acquisition growth strategy. The no-branch-closure constraint converts a typical M&A integration into a pure organizational effectiveness challenge - McChrystal's exact domain.

Revenue potential: \$500K initial diagnostic (2-3 months), \$1.5M integration operating model across key regions (6-9 months), \$400K/year ongoing advisory through the serial acquisition program.

9c. Enterprise Issues

1. Branch Redundancy Without Closure Authority: 1,400 branches across 21 states with guaranteed overlap but no authority to close - creating overstaffed markets that must find new growth to justify their cost.
2. Regional Culture Clash: Columbus, Ohio headquarters managing Houston, Jackson, and Birmingham banking operations. Local Cadence bankers built careers on community relationships that feel threatened by Midwest corporate integration.
3. System Conversion Risk: Mid-2026 conversion of all Cadence accounts to Huntington's platform. Any disruption risks deposit flight in competitive Southern markets where regional alternatives abound.
4. Merger Fatigue: Cadence employees already survived the BancorpSouth-Cadence merger in 2021. A second integration in four years tests organizational resilience and accelerates voluntary attrition among fatigued talent.
5. Synergy Capture Without Traditional Levers: \$365M target with no branch closures and an implicit pledge to minimize layoffs. Savings must come from technology, process, and organizational redesign - the hardest and slowest synergy levers.

9d. Expected Outcomes

1. Regional Integration Operating Model - Design shared consciousness mechanisms across 21 states that maintain local banking autonomy while driving shared standards. Measurable: unified customer experience scores across legacy markets within 12 months.
2. Synergy Capture Acceleration - Build cross-functional teams to identify and execute back-office consolidation

and process efficiency opportunities. Measurable: achieve 60% of \$365M target within first 18 months.

3. Cultural Integration Program - Facilitate Midwest-South cultural bridge through shared leadership forums and regional exchange programs. Measurable: Cadence region voluntary attrition below 10% (industry average 15-18% post-merger).

4. System Conversion Readiness - Organizational coordination framework for mid-2026 system cutover across 390 branches. Measurable: zero-disruption conversion with customer retention above 98%.

5. Serial Acquisition Playbook - Codify integration methodology for future acquisitions. Measurable: reduce integration timeline for next acquisition by 30%.

9e. Key Stakeholders & Business Unit Map

Consumer & Business Banking

Leader: Unknown

Function: Retail banking across 1,400 branches

McChrystal Relevance: Primary integration surface - where cultural merger happens daily

Commercial Banking

Leader: Unknown

Function: Middle-market lending, Treasury

McChrystal Relevance: Cross-sell opportunity between legacy footprints

Wealth Management

Leader: Unknown

Function: Private banking, Trust

McChrystal Relevance: High-value client retention during transition

Technology & Operations

Leader: Unknown

Function: IT, Operations

McChrystal Relevance: System conversion owner - mid-2026 high-stakes event

Southern/Texas Region (legacy Cadence)

Leader: Unknown

Function: Regional banking

McChrystal Relevance: Highest cultural friction - priority engagement zone

Engagement priorities:

1. Chief Integration Officer / SVP Integration (integration execution pain)
2. CHRO (cultural integration between Midwest and South)
3. Southern/Texas regional leaders (adoption and buy-in on the ground)
4. CEO Steinour (executive sponsor endorsement)

9f. Opportunity Thesis

Strategic Signal Convergence - Why Now: \$7.4B merger (Feb 2026) -> no-branch-closure pledge -> 21-state expansion -> mid-2026 system conversion -> serial acquisition growth strategy. The no-branch-closure constraint forces Huntington to solve the integration challenge through organizational excellence rather than cost-cutting -

McChrystal's exact value proposition.

The Structural Paradox - Why McChrystal, Not McKinsey: McKinsey would model the synergies and design the integration plan. But the unique constraint (no branch closures) means execution is everything - and execution across 21 culturally distinct states requires decentralized authority within shared consciousness, not centralized control. This is McChrystal's differentiation.

Phased Engagement Hypothesis:

- Phase 1 (\$400K-\$500K, 2-3 months): Integration diagnostic + leadership alignment workshop for top 40 leaders from both legacy banks. Beachhead: Texas and Southeast regions where cultural distance from Columbus HQ is greatest.
- Phase 2 (\$1M-\$1.5M, 6-9 months): Regional integration operating model across all 21 states, including decision rights, shared intelligence, and cross-sell coordination.
- Phase 3 (\$300K-\$400K/year): Ongoing advisory for serial acquisition integration capability.

Competitive Displacement: Enter through the integration/HR function rather than through strategy (where McKinsey/BCG likely have relationships). Position as the operating model complement to whatever strategy firm is advising.

Multi-Threaded Pursuit:

- Thread 1: Integration leader - direct outreach on post-merger integration operating models
- Thread 2: CHRO - cultural integration expertise angle
- Thread 3: CEO Steinour - check McChrystal network for banking CEO connections, military/veteran angles